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General Comment

As a somewhat recent graduate of a creative writing program, I find it critically important that the allocation of using copyrighted works to feed into generative AI is highly unethical and should not be permitted. The creators of such work have not given their permission for their work to be stolen to create inferior products that would ultimately lead to their replacement in the creative fields that showcase the truest creations of humankind. Artificial intelligence is just that, artificial. It cannot replace the human spirit when it comes to creating art, stories, essays, or any other creative endeavor. Generative AI is not the future, and further development into it would be a waste of time and resources. The companies saying otherwise are merely trying to profit off of stolen work. The advancement of AI will not benefit national security, and would more than likely harm it as it has been shown time and time again that generative AI is unreliable and extremely error prone. Allowing AI training on copyrighted works without permission would exacerbate this, as many copyrighted works contradict each other and would lead to "hallucinations" or false information generated by the AI. Additionally, AI generated content has been seen by the majority as lazy or subpar, further emphasizing that training on copyrighted material is a waste of time and resources. People would much rather see the creations of fellow people, not machines regurgitating stolen work. Furthermore, training AI on copyrighted work could leak sensitive information about businesses and institutions for anyone to see. Such secrets could be stolen and used against such businesses and institutions. Any promises of long-term profit are false. AI may seem like the hot new thing, but I find it comparable to cryptocurrency and blockchain technology. Those technologies ballooned with countless resources being poured into them only for them to fizzle out and fall into relative obscurity. Generative AI is just the second coming of that. Sooner or later, the AI bubble will burst and any resources put into it will be wasted as the markets chase another trend. And in chasing the current trend, it hurts artists and creators as companies try to cut corners by eliminating them for a short-term profit. The technology is too unstable to invest in, and training it on stolen work would ultimately undermine the copyright system. It's already been ruled that AI generated content isn't subject to copyright, so why should AI generation be allowed to train itself on copyrighted work? The humanities were meant to be human, and they should remain that way.